

Workshop

Got laptop heating issues? Time to give it a good clean. Let this workshop be your guide

**Play Music Logo**

Google Play Music logo has been changed from Headphones to a Pizza like design.
<http://dgit.in/Pizzalogo>

Setting up a computer lab, fiddling with Steam and a funky Windows 7 installation

We're certain our readers aren't alone, perhaps you're plagued with these issues as well?

Future-proof gaming

Dear Team Digit, first of all, it's nice to read your magazine so keep on great work. And now I was hoping for your help with upgrading my PC's gaming performance.

My System's Configuration are:

- Motherboard - ASRock H81M-WW
- HDD - 1 TB
- RAM - 8 GB (4 GB x 2)
- Processor - Intel Core i5 - 4440 CPU
- Graphics Card - NVIDIA GTX 960 (4 GB)
- PSU - Corsair VS550 SMPS

I am thinking about future proofing and have come to the conclusion that SLI would be the way to go. What are your thoughts?

1. Is NVIDIA SLI possible with my current graphics card. If yes, what upgrade should I go for to make it possible?
2. Is there any other good way to upgrade my pc? Do let me know.
3. This upgrade must be able to keep-up with the gaming world for at least four to five years.

I really really want a powerful AAA gaming PC. So please help me.

Thanks in advance, Digit.

—Yogesh Thakur

A If you are looking for a machine that can handle all them fancy AAA games at the very highest possible settings for the next four to five years, you're going to have to spend an awful lot of money. Games are getting really huge with high resolution textures that need a lot of graphics processing power. Your current configuration does not support SLI. SLI requires 2 PCIe slots running at 8x each at the very least. So if SLI is your goal, then you need to upgrade the motherboard to one that does support SLI. This means you'll need a motherboard based on the Z97 chipset. So



Should you SLI?

that'll be around ₹12K aside from the ₹17K it's going to cost you for a second GTX 960. If you have two stock GTX 960s then your current PSU will be brought down to its knees. If you consider an overclocked graphics card, you'd need to upgrade the power supply in this case as well. Even if you were to stick to stock cards, there might arise a situation where you'd have to overclock your graphics card for some game or the other, which again would require you to upgrade your PSU. So that's another ₹6-8K of expenditure. Your Intel Core i5 should be sufficient for the next 2 or so years without worry. So let us know what your budget is so that we can offer you a better solution.

10 PCs for 1 Lakh

Hey Agent001,

This is the first time I am mailing to you and I am in a fix. My father owns a school and I had to get some cheap stick pc's for the computer lab. But unfortunately they got overheated and now all I have is a pile of crap. So would you please tell me about some server like thing to which I can connect 10 monitors and so and that works perfectly. My budget is 100,000 including the monitors and stuff. Thanks

—Yogesh

A Hey Yogesh, you certainly do have a tight budget so the best solution that we can offer you for your situation would be Zero or Thin Client solutions. These are devices which rely on one machine for storage and processing while the remaining machines are just clients with just a monitor and a mouse and keyboard. Zero Clients and Thin Clients rely on virtualisation on the server to take care of your computational needs. There are plenty of solutions that should fit right within your budget. NComputing's X550 is one such solution where each kit comes with one PCI card and 5 clients. And the software can support two such PCI cards on one computer so you can have a total of 11 machines running off of just one computer (fat client).

First you'll need a motherboard with two PCI slots, not PCIe slots, to make this work. But since you haven't mentioned your existing hardware we don't know what exactly to recommend to you. You can also use the Raspberry Pi as a thin client so that's another viable solution that you can opt for. The Raspberry Pi is comparatively more power efficient and would not require a centralised server.

Steam Offline Client

Dear Digit, I know this might not make any sense but I have a worrisome query. I know that you can install Arkham City without having to download it and install it offline without downloading it. I do not have internet in my house and this message is being sent from a cybercafe. The point is I know that you have already answered that query from another person about Call of Duty: Black Ops 2. But I've lost the book and I want to know how. Can I also get a link for an offline Steam